

Adult Guide - E01 Something Is Here

Version 1.0.0 live edition Author: Maria Smith Audience: parents, carers, early-years practitioners and teachers

Purpose

This book introduces one careful habit: every example that can be shown, said, recorded or checked is an occurrence. An absence that is not presented supplies no counterexample. The child is not asked to settle a metaphysical question. They are invited to notice the difference between an empty container, a missing event, a spoken word and no presented example at all.

Exact SFT source

Claim: SFT-ROOT-THERE-IS-NO-NOTHING Status: independently replicated Provenance: direct forcing Closure: depth-independent within the operational boundary Receipt: sha256:711864171e4d3a2f2734f0c2890965bcd81a0228349538751a3c80699c27d669

Exact statement:

No admissible operational statement, denial, record, proof object or
derivational object is nothing: absence presents no counterexample, while
every presented counterexample is an occurrence.

The complete declared grammar has two named classes:

1. Unpresented absence supplies no statement, denial, record, trace or

identity, so it supplies no operational counterexample.

1. Presented occurrence supplies a statement, denial, record, trace or

identity; that presentation is an occurrence and is not nothing.

The theorem does not claim knowledge of an unexpressed metaphysical domain.

Learning outcomes

After repeated shared reading, a child may be able to:

- name something that is visibly or audibly presented;
- distinguish an empty object from no presented object;
- notice that speaking, writing, pointing, listening and checking are events;
- state that a missing event is not the same as no presented example;
- make a simple observation record; and
- accept agreement, disagreement or “we need to check again” without hiding the

result.

These are developmental opportunities, not pass/fail requirements.

Vocabulary

- present - available to point to, say, record or check;
- empty - a declared container lacks a named content;
- occurrence - something happening or presented at the checking boundary;
- example - the presented thing offered for checking;
- record - a retained mark, word, picture or trace of what happened;
- check - looking again or using another route to test the record;
- boundary - the exact place where a rule applies and where it stops.

Use ordinary words first. Introduce “occurrence” and “boundary” only when the child is ready.

Before reading

Prepare:

- one safe empty bowl or open box;
- one familiar toy placed out of sight;
- paper and thick pencils or crayons; and
- an optional quiet timer set for no more than a few seconds.

Do not use sealed containers, choking hazards or activities that require a child to remain silent or still against their wishes.

Page-by-page conversation prompts

Pages 3-6: the empty box

Ask: “What can you point to?” “What is not inside?” “Is an empty box the same as no box?”

Expected reasoning: the box and the observation are present; the named toy is not inside. Do not say that emptiness is a numerical zero.

Pages 7-8: no clap

Ask: “Did a clap happen?” “Did listening happen?” “Could we make a mark to show that we listened?”

Expected reasoning: no clap occurred during the declared moment; listening and recording still occurred. Avoid claiming that silence itself is a substance.

Pages 9-10: the written word

Ask: “What is on the paper?” “Does writing the word make the paper disappear?”

Expected reasoning: the word, paper and act of writing are presented occurrences. A label is not automatically the thing it names.

Pages 11-16: the complete paths

Use two large cards: EXAMPLE PRESENTED and NO EXAMPLE PRESENTED. Let the child place a sample record on the first card. Leave the second card without a sample.

Say: “If someone gives us an example, giving it is happening. If no example is given, we have no counterexample to check.”

The cards are a teaching translation. They do not replace the registered candidate census.

Pages 17-19: result and boundary

Repeat the careful form: “Every example we can show, say, record or check is something.” Do not simplify this to “we know everything exists everywhere.”

Pages 20-23: activities

Allow pointing, gesture, drawing, speech, a communication aid or a partner record. The learning goal is distinguishability and honest checking, not one communication mode.

Activity guidance and answers

Activity 1 - empty bowl

Possible present items: bowl, table, people, light, pointing or spoken record. Possible absent content: the specifically named toy is not inside the bowl.

Correct reasoning names the container and the missing named content separately. “Nothing is there” should be gently expanded to “There is no toy inside; the bowl is here.”

Activity 2 - listening moment

If no clap occurs, record “no clap during our short listening moment.” Also record that listening or timing occurred. If an unexpected sound occurs, keep it; do not restart merely to obtain quiet.

Activity 3 - second check

Agreement is allowed. Disagreement is also allowed and retained. Ask what each person observed and whether their observation boundaries were the same.

Common misconceptions

“An empty box is nothing.”

Response: the box is a presented container. It lacks the named content at the declared boundary.

“The number zero proves nothing exists.”

Response: a written symbol is a presented record. SFT does not install numerical zero as a foundational object.

“If I close my eyes, everything becomes nothing.”

Response: closing eyes changes one observation route. The act, the person and other possible records are not erased by that change.

“The theorem tells us what is beyond all possible expression.”

Response: it does not. Its exact scope is operational statements, denials, records, proof objects and derivational objects.

Observation notes

Use brief narrative notes rather than a score. Useful observations include:

- distinguishes container from content;
- names what happened and what did not happen;
- makes or interprets a simple record;
- asks for a second check;
- keeps an unexpected or disagreeing result; and
- uses speech, gesture, drawing or another communication form to show the

distinction.

Accessibility

- Read every page aloud and describe its illustration.
- Offer tactile objects for the box and cards.
- Never rely on colour alone; the two paths have text and shape labels.
- Accept nonverbal response modes.
- Reduce visual choice and repeat pages as needed.
- Allow children to opt out of the quiet-listening activity.

The semantic HTML edition contains every illustration description.

Reference-only curriculum navigation

The activities can support communication and language, personal/social development, literacy, mathematics, understanding the world and expressive arts. These links calibrate usability against England's EYFS learning areas; they are not scientific dependencies and do not validate the theorem.

Scientific checks preserved in the adult edition

The admitted claim passed the complete two-class census, minimality, named-shape uniqueness, false-premise, tampered-source, tampered-artifact and boundary controls, plus implementation-distinct reconstruction. The picture book translates those habits into presenting, retaining both paths, checking again and keeping disagreement.

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